

Jiyoung Lee

Department of Economics, University of Washington

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Education

Ph.D., Economics, University of Washington, Seattle, WA, USA 2021 – 2027 (Expected)

B.A., Economics, Korea University, Seoul, Republic of Korea 2010 – 2015

Employment History

Junior Economist, Bank of Korea 2015 – 2021

- Inflation Analysis Team, Research Department
- National Balance Sheet Team, Economic Statistics Department
- Economic Research Division, Busan Branch

Research Interests

Primary: International Macroeconomics, Geoeconomics

Secondary: Trade and Industrial Policy, Defense Economics

References

Fabio Ghironi

Paul F. Glaser Professor
Department of Economics
University of Washington
gghiro@uw.edu

Theo Eicher

Castor Professor
Department of Economics
University of Washington
te@uw.edu

Andrei Zlate

Principal Economist
Division of Monetary Affairs
Federal Reserve Board
Andrei.zlate@frb.gov

Job Market Paper

Reshoring Policies in the Intangible Economy

Abstract: How do reshoring policies affect the decisions of intangible-intensive offshoring firms, and what are the macroeconomic consequences? This paper incorporates intangible scalability into a two-country general equilibrium model with firm heterogeneity and endogenous entry, and evaluate lump-sum subsidies, tax credits, and tariffs. All three raise consumption over the medium run despite eroding offshore cost advantages, but through different channels: tax credits maximize reshoring value-added by attracting high-productivity firms, lump-sum subsidies deliver the largest transitional welfare gains through wage growth, and tariffs depress output by shrinking foreign demand and offshore value-added. The Ramsey-optimal policy mix pairs a lump-sum reshoring subsidy equal to 8.4% of offshore profits with a 13.1% tariff and raises Home welfare by 4.0%. Because offshoring intangible investment entails high fixed costs that amplify location and entry distortions, reshoring intangibles can raise welfare even as it fragments global production.

– **Presentations:** CEPR-Kiel-Bocconi Best Paper Award Finalist: 2nd Junior Workshop in Geoeconomics (Bocconi University), 2026 Royal Economic Society (University of Newcastle), The 8th Annual CefES Conference (ETH Zürich), The 3rd Workshop of the East and South-East Asian Macroeconomic Society (HKUST), Midwest International Trade and Theory Conference (Toronto Metropolitan University, Scheduled)

– **Awards:** RES 2026 Annual Conference: Scholars Fund — Rated Excellent by Committee, Royal Economic Society; Henry T. Buechel Memorial Fellowship, University of Washington

Working Papers

The Effect of Intangible Capital on Offshoring

Abstract: This paper analyzes the impact of intangible capital on firms' offshoring decisions, aggregate productivity, and external competitiveness. I develop a two-country offshoring model with endogenous intangible investment that captures its unique scalability in a framework featuring heterogeneous firm entry and exit. The model successfully replicates the key post-GFC U.S. empirical regularities—the coexistence of aggregate productivity gains and real exchange rate appreciation. Following a positive productivity shock, the entry of domestic firms lowers average firm productivity and raises domestic prices, thereby amplifying the Harrod–Balassa–Samuelson effect. Furthermore, incorporating intangibles yields substantially larger aggregate productivity gains than non-intangible models by improving resource allocation. This research contributes by endogenously modeling the scalability of intangible capital—a crucial yet previously understudied factor in offshoring models.

Presentations: 2026 SMU Trade Conference (Singapore Management University), The 18th FIW Research Conference “International Economics” (WU Vienna), Boston College 2nd PhD Conference, HEC Paris Economics PhD Conference (HEC Paris), PhD–EVS

War and Macro (with Fabio Ghironi, University of Washington; Daisoon Kim, North Carolina State University; and Galip Kemal Ozhan, IMF) [[Abstract](#)]

Work in Progress

AI and Trade (Sangwoo Park, University of Washington and Bank of Korea)

Research Experience

Research Assistant, National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER) 2025 – 2026
– Supervisor: Professor Fabio Ghironi
– Project: “International Trade and Macroeconomic Dynamics with Sanctions” (NSF Award No. 2317089)

Conferences and Training

World Congress of the Econometric Society, Seoul (Attended) 2025
Journal of International Economics Summer School, University of Oxford (Selected) 2024
AEA CSWEP Mentorship for PhD Students, Washington, DC (Selected; AEA travel grant) 2024
Eurostat Conference on Quality in Official Statistics, Kraków (Attended) 2018

Fellowships, Honors, and Awards

Henry T. Buechel Memorial Fellowship, University of Washington 2026
[RES 2026 Annual Conference: Scholars Fund, Royal Economic Society](#) 2026
Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award (×2), University of Washington 2026
The Steven Langton Teaching Award, University of Washington 2024
Travel Award (\$3,500), National Science Foundation (via Prof. Fabio Ghironi) 2024
Doctoral Study Abroad Fellowship (\$193,920), Bank of Korea 2021 – 2023
– Granted to 6 junior economists annually; providing two years of tuition, living expenses, and salary
2nd Prize, Young Economist Research Paper Competition (\$3,500), Bank of Korea 2016

Scholarship for Academic Excellence (\$11,000), Inbong Scholarship Foundation	2012 – 2013
Scholarship for Superior Academic Performance, Korea University	2011

Policy Papers

Implications of Financial Support for SMEs after COVID-19: Focus on the Busan Area, <i>Golden Book, Best Regional Working Paper Place</i> , Bank of Korea (Korean) [Paper Link]	2020
Comparison Between COVID-19 and Past Crises, <i>Golden Book, Best Regional Working Paper Place</i> , Bank of Korea (Korean) [Paper Link]	2020
Recent Housing Consumption Behavior of the Baby Boomer Generation and Its Implications, <i>Monthly Bulletin</i> , Bank of Korea [Paper Link]	2017
Inflation Target for 2016 Onwards, <i>Inflation Report</i> , Bank of Korea	2016
Using Microdata to Reinterpret the Effect of Inflation Expectations on Consumption, <i>2nd Thesis Prize, Bank of Korea Young Economist Research Paper Competition</i> , co-authored with Heewan Jeong and Youngchul You	2016
Current Status and Implications of the Inflation Targeting Countries, <i>Inflation Report</i> , Bank of Korea (Korean) [Paper Link]	2016

Presentations

CEPR-Kiel-Bocconi Best Paper Award Finalist: 2nd Junior Workshop in Geoeconomics (Bocconi University), 2026 Royal Economic Society (University of Newcastle, <i>RES Scholars Fund Recipient</i>), The 8th Annual CefES Conference (ETH Zürich), The 18th FIW Research Conference “International Economics” (WU Vienna), 2026 SMU Trade Conference (Singapore), Boston College 2nd PhD Conference in Economics, HEC Paris Economics PhD Conference (HEC Paris), Midwest International Trade and Theory Conference (Toronto Metropolitan University, Scheduled), The 3rd Workshop of the East and South-East Asian Macroeconomic Society (HKUST), PhD – EVS, UW Honors Research Seminar [†]	2026
Macro Brown Bag Seminar & Macro Workshop, University of Washington	2024 –

[†] Presented by co-author

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, University of Washington	<i>Overall Mean Evaluation: 4.8 / 5.0</i>
– Intermediate Macroeconomics (Undergraduate, × 2)	Spring 2026
– Introductory Macroeconomics (Undergraduate, × 6)	2023 – 2026
– Introductory Microeconomics (Undergraduate, × 2)	2025
Samsung Dream Class Program Tutor (Korea University Middle School)	2012 – 2013
– Tutored low-income middle school students in mathematics	

Misc.

Programming: MATLAB, STATA, R, Eviews, and LaTeX

Languages: Korean (native), English (fluent)

Citizenship: Republic of Korea

Gender: Female